The Southeast

Stretching between the northern area of the Gulf of Mexico and just south of the Northeast region, the Southeast possessed a lush and warm area suitable for agriculture. The majority of the Native Americans who lived in this region were skilled farmers. They grew foods such as sunflowers, butternut squash, maize, tobacco and created small but thriving communities referred to as hamlets. Out of all the people living in the Southeast region, the best known are the Seminole, Choctaw and the Cherokee. There is evidence to suggest that they spoke dialects belonging to the Muskogean language.

After the United States declared itself independent from the British Empire, most of the cultures living in this region were either killed by diseases or were displaced by the Europeans. The Indian Removal Act of 1830 forced the remaining natives from their lands so that the settlers could build homes for themselves. Over the next eight years, almost 100,000 Native Americans from the Cherokee were forced to travel to an area referred to as Indian Territory. This area was located in modern day Oklahoma and had a devastating effect on the Cherokee. The natives refer to this journey as the Trail of Tears.